

BACK TO SCHOOL Revanth Reddy during the inauguration of the first Telangana Public School at Arutla, Ranga Reddy district, Jun. 17

> **"EVERY STUDENT MUST BE EQUIPPED TO COMPETE WITH THE WORLD. QUALITY EDUCATION AND NUTRITIOUS FOOD MUST GO HAND IN HAND"**
>
> **REVANTH REDDY,** Chief Minister, Telangana

caste- and community-based residential schools that have operated under the government system in united Andhra Pradesh and later Telangana for decades, catering separately to SCs, STs, OBCs and minorities. "The YIIRS will bring children from different social and economic backgrounds together in a common learning environment," says Dr Naveen Nicolas, director, school education.

BRINGING BACK STUDENTS

The Mandal Parishad Primary School at Rangapur village, just off the Hyderabad-Kodangal highway, offers a glimpse of how the introduction of pre-primary education in government schools is helping attract parents who might otherwise opt for private schools. The school now has 40 students, including eight in Nursery, four in LKG and one in UKG. With enrolment in government schools declining, the government hopes that the addition of pre-primary classes and the breakfast scheme will bring more students back into the fold. "As parents become aware of the pre-primary classes and the facilities provided—free books, uniforms, learning equipment and now morning breakfast—we expect enrolment to rise further next year," says headmistress M. Basaveswari.

The government has also expanded the range of supplies provided to students. In addition to the uniforms, textbooks, notebooks and workbooks supplied until 2023-24, the present government has added a tie, belt, ID card holder, black and white pairs of